

FieldPulse Dispatcher Interview Transcripts | TPM Academy

Dispatcher Interview Transcripts — FieldPulse Research Packet

Ambient context introduced Day 1; used from Day 3 (Personas) onward.

Three anonymized dispatcher interviews plus two ride-along field notes. Quotes are **Reported** evidence (what a person said). Observed behaviors and ride-along notes are **Observed** evidence (what the researcher watched happen). Nothing here is analyzed for you — that's the week's work. Do **not** treat any single quote as a validated fact; corroborate across sources and tag every claim's tier.

Anonymized: names changed, shop sizes preserved within a band, identifying details removed.

Interview A — “Maria R.”

Profile: 12 years dispatching · 90-technician HVAC shop · runs the board solo on weekdays

Quotes (Reported)

1. “Re-routing mid-day is the part of this job that ages me. One tech calls out and I’m on the phone to three or four others before the board even reflects it.”
2. “I keep a paper notebook for what’s on each truck. The app has it, but it’s three taps deep and by the time I get there I’ve forgotten which truck I was checking.”
3. “End of the day I’m here another 45 minutes just typing in what came back on paper from the guys who couldn’t submit in the field.”
4. “My whole reputation is the arrival window. If I tell a customer ‘between 1 and 3’ I will move heaven and earth to make that true.”
5. “I don’t trust the app’s inventory number by Thursday. It’s always drifted. Payroll is usually how we find out something’s off.”
6. “The new dispatchers we hire never make it through the setup screens. I end up walking them through it at my desk.”
7. “I’ve been doing this twelve years. I can look at the board and feel when a day’s about to go sideways — the software can’t do that yet.”
8. “Honestly? Half my day is keeping the picture straight in my head. The tools help with the picture, they don’t hold it for me.”

Observed behaviors (Observed)

- Retypes paper tickets into the system after shift end — observed on 6 of 8 ride-alongs.
 - Keeps a physical parts notebook next to the keyboard; updates it instead of the app's inventory view.
 - Re-routes by phone: calls technicians individually rather than using the board's reassign flow.
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Interview B — “Trey W.”

Profile: 3 years dispatching · former field technician (5 years in the field) · 60-technician shop

Quotes (Reported)

1. “I was a tech for five years, so I open the mobile app myself every morning just to see what my guys are going to see. It's not always the same as my board.”
2. “When the schedule syncs slow, a tech shows up to a job that got moved twenty minutes ago. That happened to me once and now I text them directly to be sure.”
3. “In-app messaging is fine until it's busy. When it's busy I go back to plain text messages because I *know* those land.”
4. “The reconcile screen at the end of the day — I watch guys just give up on it and hand me paper instead.”
5. “Being a former tech helps me here more than any training did. I know why they cut corners, because I cut the same ones.”
6. “I don't need it to be pretty. I need to trust that what's on my screen is what's actually happening in the field.”

Observed behaviors (Observed)

- Cross-checks the dispatcher board against the technician mobile app each morning before assigning.
 - Falls back to SMS for time-sensitive messages instead of in-app messaging.
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Interview C — “Susana O.”

Profile: 18 years dispatching · 160-technician shop · the owner's daughter; also runs weekly reporting

Quotes (Reported)

1. “I run the numbers for my dad every Friday. What he asks about is always the same: did we hit our windows, and did we bill everything we did.”
2. “I keep a spreadsheet next to FieldPulse. Not because I want to — because there are three questions it can't answer in the shape he asks them.”

3. “We miss revenue when work gets done and the paperwork doesn’t catch up. That’s the reconcile problem, and it’s a money problem, not a screen problem.”
4. “I train every new dispatcher. I can tell you the exact screen where they check out — it’s the setup flow, about five screens in.”
5. “At our size, a half-percent of missed jobs is a real number. I feel it before the report shows it.”
6. “The techs aren’t the problem. The handoff between the office and the truck is where things fall on the floor.”
7. “If this told me on Wednesday what I only find out on Friday, I’d get two days of my week back.”

Observed behaviors (Observed)

- Maintains a parallel spreadsheet for three owner-facing metrics not available in FieldPulse reports.
 - Reviews reconcile completeness weekly and flags jobs that were worked but not fully closed out.
 - Onboards new dispatchers personally; observed three new hires stall at the same onboarding step.
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Ride-along field note — Maria R. (Tuesday shift)

One researcher, full shift, observation only.

- **7:05** — Maria has the board up and a paper notebook open before the first tech clocks in. She copies today’s truck stock into the notebook from memory and a quick app check.
- **7:40** — A tech calls out. Maria spends ~9 minutes on the phone re-routing four jobs to two trucks. The board is updated *last*, after the calls.
- **11:20** — A customer calls about an arrival window. Maria answers from the board instantly; this is clearly the part of the system she trusts most.
- **2:15** — Maria taps toward the inventory view, stops at the second screen, and writes in the paper notebook instead.
- **5:10** — Shift ends. Six paper tickets from field techs are stacked by the keyboard. Maria spends ~45 minutes typing them into the reconcile flow. She abandons the flow once partway and restarts.

Ride-along field note — Trey W. (Thursday shift)

- **6:50** — Before assigning anything, Trey opens the technician mobile app on his own phone and scrolls the day as a tech would see it.
- **9:30** — A schedule change doesn’t appear to sync for several minutes; Trey texts the affected tech directly rather than trust the board reflected it.
- **1:00** — Trey watches a tech attempt the field submit, fail on a weak signal, and set the ticket aside on paper. Trey notes it without surprise.

- **4:40** — At reconcile, Trey does the paper tickets himself rather than ask the techs to redo them in-app.